

Samsung SGH-i450

Samsung on Symbian

Another Samsung, another slider phone—the i450 is however, based around a Symbian S60 platform which is rare for Samsung phones. The slider mechanism isn't the best we've seen and by Samsungs standards is quite mediocre to be honest. Build quality is good, but once again the pizzazz that was present in the costlier phones is curiously absent and sorely missed. The keypad is well laid out and easy to use. The large buttons on the front fascia are also rather difficult to misuse, and the menu system is very intuitive—typical Symbian. The high resolution screen measures 2.4 inches diagonally, but uses an outdated panel (256,000 colours). The 2.0 megapixel camera is also strictly included simply for the sake of including a camera—it's only good for the odd shot or so. Music quality is good, and music aficionados won't be disappointed.

Overall, the SGH-i450 is a phone that is overpriced in our opinion, although it's not a bad phone. Sadly the price puts in a league where it gets hammered by some unrelenting competition. Such features and performance can be found for a lot less if you take a look at our tables. At Rs 16,799 you can afford to give this one a wide berth.

Sony Ericsson W890

Walkman on a diet

The W890 is one of the newer walkman phones around. Its dimensions are extremely compact, and the phone is very slim (half the thickness of the N95 8 GB!). The screen although small (2 inches) sports a high resolution of 240 x 320 pixels and at 78 grams the W890 won't damage your shirt pocket. Build



Sony Ericsson W890



Samsung SGH-i450



Nokia 6500 Slide

quality is also pretty good, and although metal (quite obviously) hasn't been used in the construction everything feels solid and well put together even after a week of usage.

The keypad is slightly cramped, but taking into consideration that this is a small phone SE has done a commendable job of using every available millimetre of space to prevent the keypad from becoming a serious hindrance to usage.

The W890 is a snappy phone, and it has a snappy 3.15 megapixel camera that offers some good results, although not as good as a dedicated camera phone would offer.

In terms of connectivity the W890 is loaded, and WiFi is the only trick it misses out on. If you're looking for a very compact, light phone with good music quality and a good camera for the price point of Rs 15,000 or so then the W890 makes a good buy at Rs 15,495. If the dimensions and weight aren't of any consequence take a look at the next contender.

Nokia 6500 Slide

Heavily armoured foe

Nokia's 6500 has the best slider mechanism we've seen from any Nokia phone barring the Sirocco. Its outer body is built out of brushed steel, which exudes a quality feel. Needless to say the phone's heavy, although you'd be hard pressed to find better build quality. The keypad is well laid out, although the buttons are a little flat—we'd like a little more bevelling to impart feedback. The quality of accessories is as good as we've seen, and a TV out cable has been provided; just like the N95 8GB and the N82—both much costlier phones.

The 2.2-inch screen features a high resolution of 240 x 320 pixels and has a rich 16 million colours. Camera and music playback quality are well above par, although not enough to sway a purchasing decision solely on their performance. GPS and WiFi are the only features that the 6500 Slide misses out on. Although it's built well, the look itself is unexciting, and may not inspire interest when compared to its beautiful siblings.

At Rs 15,219 the 6500 Slide makes a good buy for someone looking for a feature-rich, usable and very sturdy cellphone. Expect too much in the way of sex appeal from it and you're going to be disappointed.

Nokia 6110 Navigator

The North Star? Not really...

The 6110 has been graced with the suffix *navigator* mainly because of the inbuilt GPS and the fact that it supports Nokia Maps. While also a slider phone like the 6500 Slide, build quality of the slider mechanism and the device itself is no match for its superior sibling. The body is made of cheaper, plastic materials. The keypad is flat, but reasonably well laid out and using it is largely ergonomic.



Nokia 6110 Navigator

On the multimedia front the 6110 Navigator has a 2.0 megapixel camera that is largely cosmetic. It has decent PMP capabilities and music quality is good, as is video playback, courtesy the crisp 2.2 inch screen that could have been bigger especially considering the GPS function. It's priced identically to the 6500 Slide (Rs 15,219), and has a couple of additions and a couple of reductions. Build quality is nowhere as good, and if cellphone integrated GPS is really your thing there are better, albeit costlier, options. Those who want a good camera phone that's flashy looking, will look elsewhere. It makes a sweet buy for those looking for a cheap, reliable GPS-enabled phone.

The Magnificent Five

Multimedia Cell Phones
Rs 20,000 and above

Nokia N95 8GB

The return of the King

Bulky by today's standards the N95 8GB is a wonderfully functional device that exemplifies the phrase *all-in-one*. It looks slightly dated now, but the mix of rubberised black rear finish and glossy black front finish still grabs attention, as does the beautiful, crisp 2.8 inch screen and the unique 2-way slider. The chrome buttons atop the front add a very PDA-like feeling, but unfortunately the large, gorgeous screen isn't touch capable. The menu button and keypad layout is very good, and with a load of shortcut keys the N95 8GB is very ergonomic. With features like built in GPS and support for Nokia Maps, and a built-in 8 GB of storage, in addition to goodies like WiFi and a 5 megapixel camera this phone has something for everyone. The upgraded battery (1200 mAh) gives more talk time and the signal and voice clarity are absolutely excellent.

When it comes to features the N95 8GB is a phone with



Nokia N95 8GB

8 GB of storage? Thanks.

Nokia N82

Next in line

For those who don't have the moolah to buy the N95 8GB, or want something more compact the N82 will appeal. For one it's solidly built, although the keypad is very cramped and will take some getting used to, even if you happen to have long nails. Feature wise it's identical to its costlier sibling, but loses out on the slick double slider and adds a much needed powerful Xenon flash. Although the screen isn't as good as the N95 8GB, what is appreciated is the compactness of this device, and the fact that Nokia managed to fit everything into a shell that is 25 percent smaller in volume.

Although the N82 may have the same hardware but it looks and feels different enough to have a unique personality. For one, its music quality isn't as good as the N95 8GB—which it

a genuine case of a split personality—it offers nearly everything to almost every possible user. And this is its major strength and major flaw. It's a brilliant device that was the first of its kind and has spawned many. No surprise its price tag is still somewhat high—Rs 28,000. Amongst our complaints and suggestions for improvements are a slightly larger screen (3.2 inches), a better battery, touchscreen, and a Xenon flash for the camera, and the slider mechanism from the Nokia's Sirocco series. And can it be a little slimmer? And can we get more than

will be inevitably be compared to. Secondly, and more importantly, signal and voice quality isn't as good as its costlier sibling, and the keypad isn't much fun either—Nokia needs to take a lesson from some of the Sony Ericsson phones when it comes to designing costly phones' keypads. A small gripe, but a gripe nonetheless. The average college kid will still be happy flashing this phone around, and with its build quality it should weather daily usage well. At Rs 22,499 it's a very good, feature-rich, and hot looking phone—but it's not as usable as its costlier sibling.



Nokia N82

LG KU990 (Viewty)

Mass Appeal

LGs KU990 a.k.a. Viewty is a phone that should get instant attention owing to its rather unique looks. Some may love it, some may hate it—but everyone will notice it. We found the chrome strips down the side and the rear of the phone pretty atrocious—in a bad way. Feature-wise the Viewty has all the good-